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Bid Approval and Governance SOP: VI Business (India)

1. Executive Purpose and Document Scope

The Bid Approval and Governance Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) formally dictates the mandatory qualification, evaluation, and approval lifecycle for all enterprise Request for Proposals (RFPs), Request for Quotations (RFQs), and proactive enterprise managed service pitches at VI Business (India).

This SOP ensures that all commercial commitments, technical architectures, and legal obligations presented to external enterprise customers are rigorously vetted, internally aligned, and financially viable before submission.

2. Definitions, Assumptions, and Applicability

Definitions:

- **TCV:** Total Contract Value (in INR).
- **Deal Desk:** The cross-functional committee responsible for reviewing complex, high-value, or non-standard commercial constructs.
- **NFA:** Note for Approval; the formal internal system ledger for tracking executive sign-offs.
- **Bid Coordinator (BC):** The primary project manager accountable for the RFP response execution.

Assumptions:

- All financial thresholds mentioned in this document are strictly in Indian Rupees (INR).
- Compliance with this SOP is mandatory; any bid submitted without the requisite registered NFA approvals is considered ultra vires and voids Sales Incentive Plan (SIP) eligibility.

Applicability:

- **Target Audience:** Enterprise Account Managers (AMs), Bid Coordinators, Solution Architects, Commercial Finance, and Legal Counsel.

3. Bid Qualification Workflow

Before resources are committed to drafting a response, the opportunity must pass the Go/No-Go Qualification Gate.

3.1 Qualification Parameters

The Account Manager must submit a preliminary Opportunity Brief into Salesforce, detailing:

1. **Strategic Fit:** Does this align with our core connectivity, SD-WAN, or managed security portfolios?

2. **Win Probability:** Is there an existing relationship or a clear competitive differentiator?
3. **Revenue Threshold:** Does the estimated TCV exceed the minimum INR 10 Lakhs threshold for bespoke RFP resource allocation?

3.2 Go/No-Go Decision Matrix

Opportunity TCV (INR)	Primary Approver	Turnaround SLA
10 Lakhs – 1 Crore	Regional Sales Head	24 Hours
1 Crore – 10 Crores	National Sales Head	48 Hours
> 10 Crores	Chief Enterprise Business Officer (CEBO)	72 Hours

If rejected (No-Go), the AM must utilize standard off-the-shelf pricing sheets rather than bespoke Bid Management resources.

4. Technical, Commercial, and Legal Approval Gates

Once qualified, the bid enters the concurrent drafting and review phase. All three core pillars must grant explicit approval prior to submission.

4.1 Technical Solution Approval

- **Owner:** Solution Engineering (SE) Team
- **Criteria:** Validation of the proposed architecture against existing VI Core Networks capabilities (e.g., verifying fiber feasibility, NOC/SOC bandwidth capability, SD-WAN compatibility).
- **Sign-Off Requirement:** The Lead Solution Architect must digitally sign the proposed Bill of Materials (BoM) and the technical compliance matrix.

4.2 Commercial and Financial Approval

- **Owner:** Enterprise Commercial Finance
- **Criteria:** The proposed margin must meet the VIL baseline Internal Rate of Return (IRR) hurdle of 15%. Total cost of ownership (Capex + Opex) must be modeled across the standard 3-year or 5-year contract term.
- **Sign-Off Requirement:** Head of Enterprise Commercials.

4.3 Legal and Risk Approval

- **Owner:** Enterprise Legal Counsel
- **Criteria:** Review of the customer's Master Services Agreement (MSA), liability caps, Service Level Agreement (SLA) penalties, and Data Protection considerations (DPDP Act 2023).
- **Sign-Off Requirement:** Legal confirmation detailing accepted terms and explicitly registered deviations in the `Deviation or Fallback Legal Positions Guide`.

5. Exception Approvals (The Deal Desk)

Non-standard bids require escalation to the Enterprise Deal Desk.

Triggers for Deal Desk Escalation:

1. Negative projected margin or IRR below 15%.

2. Requests for SLA commitments exceeding standard boundaries (e.g., requesting <30ms SD-WAN failover or >99.99% availability).
3. Liability caps exceeding 100% of the 12-month trailing contract value.
4. Capital Expenditure (Capex) requirements exceeding INR 5 Crores upfront.

Deal Desk Composition: Chaired by the CEBO (Arvind Nevatia), with mandatory attendance from the CFO (Enterprise), Head of Legal, and Head of Core Networks.

6. Timeline Expectations and SLAs

To prevent last-minute rushed submissions, Bid Management enforces a strict T-Minus schedule culminating at the RFP submission deadline (T-0).

Milestone	Action Required	SLA (Days Prior to T-0)
Go/No-Go Gate	Qualification approved, BC assigned.	T-14 Days
First Draft	Technical BoM & first-pass pricing complete.	T-7 Days
Red Team Review	Critical internal review of compliance and narrative.	T-5 Days
Final NFA Sign-Off	All Technical, Commercial, and Legal gates cleared.	T-3 Days
Document Production	Formatting, printing, and digital packaging.	T-1 Day
Submission	Upload to customer portal or physical delivery.	T-0

7. Roles and Sign-Offs Summary

Role	Responsibility	Authority Level
Account Manager (AM)	Opportunity origination, customer intelligence, pricing strategy.	Proposer
Bid Coordinator (BC)	End-to-end project management, timeline enforcement, document assembly.	Orchestrator
Solution Architect (SA)	Technical BoM creation, feasibility confirmation.	Technical Authority
Commercial Finance	P&L modeling, margin approval, pricing validation.	Financial Authority
Legal Counsel	Contract risk assessment, SLA penalty review.	Risk Authority
CEBO	Deal Desk final arbiter for extreme strategic opportunities.	Executive Sign-Off (>10Cr)

8. Constraints, Exclusions, and Dependencies

- **Exclusions:** This SOP does not apply to consumer mobile (B2C) operations or wholesale carrier interconnect agreements.
- **Dependencies:** Bid progression is strictly dependent on the AM securing precise site coordinates for immediate fiber feasibility checks via the internal GIS tool.

9. Proposal-Use Guidance

- **RFP Use:** Extract section 6 (Timeline Expectations) and Section 4 (Approval Gates) when customers request detail on VI Business's "Internal Quality and Governance Controls."
- **Audit Compliance:** DO NOT modify the roles or thresholds in this document when responding to RFPs; these reflect actual internal audit controls aligned with ISO 27001 policies.

10. Governance and Ownership

- **Owner:** Head of Enterprise Bid Management
- **Reviewers:** Legal, Finance, Head of Core Networks, CEBO
- **Update Cadence:** Annual, or immediately following any structural reorganization within the Enterprise Business Unit.